Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam-

Second Semester MGU-UGP – BSW (Honours) Regular Examination March 2026

MDC -- MG2MDCSWK100 - Human Behaviour And Life Span Development **- QP CODE**: 25901786 –

Part A Short Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 3 marks

1.Define **Structuralism** – ➢ Structuralism is an early school of psychology that focuses on **analyzing the structure of the mind** by breaking down mental processes into basic components like sensations, feelings, and images ➢ It uses **introspection** to examine conscious experiences. ➢ Associated with Wilhelm Wundt and Edward Titchener.	[K] / [CO1] 3 marks
2. Define Environmental Psychology and its importance. **Definition:** Environmental psychology is the study of the relationship between human behavior and the physical environment, including natural environments, built environments, and social settings. **Importance:** • Enhances the design of living and working spaces. • Promotes sustainability and eco-friendly behavior. • Improves mental well-being through better environmental planning. • Helps in disaster response and recovery through understanding of human-environment interaction.	[K] / [CO1] 1 marks 2 marks
3. Define Personality and its types Personality refers to the **unique and relatively stable patterns of thoughts, feelings, and behaviors** that characterize an individual. **Types of Personality:** • **Type A** – Competitive, aggressive, time-conscious • **Type B** – Relaxed, patient, less stressed • **Type C** – Passive, cooperative, suppresses emotions	[K] / [CO2] 1 marks 2 marks
4. Define reinforcement and its types Reinforcement is a concept in Behaviorism that refers to any stimulus that **strengthens or increases the likelihood of a behavior**. **Types:** • **Positive Reinforcement** – Adding a reward (e.g., praise) • **Negative Reinforcement** – Removing an unpleasant stimulus (e.g., stopping noise)	[K] / [CO3] 1.5 marks 1.5 marks
5. List the five levels of needs mentioned in the theory of Maslow Proposed by Abraham Maslow: 1. Physiological needs 2. Safety needs 3. Love and belongingness 4. Esteem needs 5. Self-actualization	[K] / [CO6 3 marks]
6. Name and briefly describe the major stages in the human life span ➢ **Infancy (0–2 yrs)** – Rapid physical and sensory development ➢ **Early Childhood (2–6 yrs)** – Language and basic skills develop ➢ **Middle Childhood (6–12 yrs)** – Social and academic growth ➢ **Adolescence (12–18 yrs)** – Identity formation and emotional changes ➢ **Adulthood (18+ yrs)** – Responsibilities, relationships, and career	[K] / [CO4] 3 marks
7. Define Abnormality ➢ Abnormality refers to **deviation from normal behavior or social norms**. ➢ It involves **distress or impaired functioning**. ➢ It may require **psychological or medical intervention**.	[K] / [CO5 3 marks

Part B Short Essay Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 10 marks

8. Explain the utility of Humanistic and Cognitive Approaches in addressing Human behaviour. **Humanistic Approach:** o Focuses on **individual potential**, personal growth, and **self-actualization**.	[A] / [CO2] 5 marks

○ Helps in understanding **subjective experiences**, emotions, and **self-concept**. ○ Useful in therapy (e.g., **client-centered therapy** by Carl Rogers), education, and counseling by promoting **self-awareness** and **positive self-regard**. **Cognitive Approach:** ○ Emphasizes **mental processes** such as perception, memory, thinking, and problem-solving. ○ Useful in **understanding irrational thoughts**, treating **cognitive distortions** (as in CBT), and improving **learning strategies**. ○ Provides insights into **decision-making**, attention, and language use. Together, these approaches offer a **holistic understanding of human behavior**, addressing both emotional needs (humanistic) and intellectual processes (cognitive).	5 marks
9. Elaborate on defence mechanisms and its types Defence mechanisms are **unconscious psychological strategies** that protect individuals from anxiety and internal conflicts. 1. The concept was introduced by Sigmund Freud and further developed by Anna Freud. 2. They help the **ego balance demands** of the id, superego, and reality. 3. Defence mechanisms reduce **emotional distress** without solving the underlying problem. **Types of Defence mechanism** ➢ **Repression** – pushing painful thoughts into the unconscious mind. ➢ **Denial** – refusing to accept reality or facts (common in trauma or illness). ➢ **Projection** – attributing one's own unacceptable feelings to others. ➢ **Displacement** – redirecting emotions to a safer substitute target. ➢ **Regression** – reverting to earlier developmental behaviors under stress (e.g., childlike behavior). ➢ **Rationalization & Sublimation** – justifying behavior logically or channeling impulses into socially acceptable activities (healthy mechanism).	[An] / [CO6] 4 marks 6 marks
10. Analyze the importance of Piaget's cognitive stages in understanding the behavior of a child. Jean Piaget proposed that children develop through **four cognitive stages**. ➢ Helps understand how children **think differently from adults**, not just less intelligently. ➢ **Sensor motor stage (0–2 yrs)** explains learning through senses and object permanence. ➢ **Preoperational stage (2–7 yrs)** highlights egocentrism and symbolic thinking. ➢ **Concrete operational stage (7–11 yrs)** shows logical thinking about concrete objects. ➢ **Formal operational stage (11+ yrs)** explains abstract and hypothetical thinking. ➢ Assists teachers and social workers in designing **age-appropriate interventions**. ➢ Helps explain **behavioral limitations**, such as inability to understand others' perspectives. ➢ Useful in identifying **developmental delays or cognitive impairments**. ➢ Supports effective communication by aligning with the child's **level of understanding**.	[An]/ [CO4] 10 marks
11. Analyze the impact of group behavior on individual identity. ➢ Group behavior strongly shapes **individual beliefs, values, and attitudes**. ➢ Individuals often conform due to **social pressure** (conformity). ➢ The theory of social identity was developed by Henri Tajfel. ➢ Group membership gives a sense of **belonging and self-esteem**. ➢ **Peer groups** significantly influence behavior, especially during adolescence. ➢ Can lead to **positive outcomes** like cooperation, teamwork, and social support. ➢ May also result in **negative effects** like peer pressure, groupthink, or loss of individuality. ➢ Individuals may change behavior to match **group norms and expectations**. ➢ Group identity can influence **decision-making and moral judgments**. ➢ Understanding group behavior helps social workers manage **group dynamics and interventions effectively**.	[A] / [CO5] 10 marks